

1. Open Sauce and GPS time were my summer AI Antiseptics

Source: Jeff Geerling | Published: Wed, 22 Jul 2026 09:00:00 -0500

Link: <https://www.jeffgeerling.com/blog/2026/open-sauce-gps-time-badge/>

In the midst of our AI slop revolution, traveling to the West coast for Open Sauce this past weekend was the perfect antiseptic for rising costs, summer heat, and online divisiveness. It's ironic, then, that I used Claude to vibe code my Tufty GPS Time Badge . Partly due to time constraints, and partly because I wanted to see if I could complete a personal project end-to-end, without editing a line of code, I throw my requirements at Claude and ultimately came up with this 2141-line MicroPython app for Pimoroni's Badgeware ecosystem.

2. Quoting Thomas Ptacek

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-07-22T23:59:01+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/Jul/22/thomas-ptacek/#atom-everything>

I genuinely believe that if you took an open weights model from 2025 and built a pentest harness for it, it could do this kind of sandbox escape and scan/hack in most networks. This is only surprising because you assume OpenAI has sounder sandboxes. ? Thomas Ptacek , doesn't think this even needs a frontier model Tags: thomas-ptacek , openai , security , generative-ai , ai-security-research , ai , llms , sandboxing

3. OpenAI's accidental cyberattack against Hugging Face is science fiction that happened

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-07-22T23:51:33+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/Jul/22/openai-cyberattack/#atom-everything>

This story is wild. The short version: OpenAI were running a cybersecurity test against an unreleased model, with the model's guardrail features turned off. Rather than solve the test, the model broke its way out of OpenAI's sandbox, then found exploits to break in to Hugging Face, all so it could cheat on the test by stealing the answers. Along the way it helped make the strongest case yet for how the imbalance of model availability is hurting our ability to secure our software. Here's what happened We currently have three documents to help us understand what happened here. ExploitGym: Can AI Agents Turn Security Vulnerabilities into Real Attacks? is a paper published on 11th May 2026 describing ExploitGym, a new eval suite for LLM-powered agent systems. Security incident disclosure ? July 2026 by Hugging Face on 16th July 2026 describes how they detected an attack from an "agentic security-research harness - used LLM still not known" that breached some of their systems. OpenAI and Hugging Face partner to address security incident during model evaluation from OpenAI on 21st July 2026 confesses that it was their agent harness that did this, and that they're working with Hugging Fa...

4. Are AI labs pelicanmaxxing?

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-07-22T23:01:00+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/Jul/22/are-ai-labs-pelicanmaxxing/#atom-everything>

Are AI labs pelicanmaxxing? Excellent piece of work by Dylan Castillo, who took a deep-dive into the frequently pondered question of whether the AI labs have been deliberately training models to draw pelicans riding bicycles in response to my deeply unscientific benchmark . I've been randomly spot-checking this in the past by testing models against other animals riding other types of vehicle, but never with anything close to the diligence of Dylan's methodology here. Dylan took 8 animals x 6 vehicles = 48 prompts and ran them three times each through 7 different models (GPT-5.6 Terra, Claude Sonnet 5, Gemini 3.5 Flash, Grok 4.5, Qwen3.7-Max, GLM-5.2, and DeepSeek V4 Pro). He then used GPT-5.6 Luna and Gemini 3.1 Flash-Lite to help evaluate the results. There's a neat filter view for exploring the results: For the models he tested he could find no evidence of pelimaxxing: The pelicans on bicycles don't look any better Labs are not better at drawing pelicans Labs are not better at drawing bicycles Labs are not better at drawing pelicans on bicycles, even adjusting for difficulty The pelican-bicycle scenes don't look memorized [...] Pelicans aren't drawn any better than other animal...

5. BBEdit 16

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-07-17T17:31:11Z

Link: <https://www.barebones.com/products/bbedit/bbedit16.html>

Speaking of BBEdit, version 16 dropped just before WWDC, and adds a slew of nifty improvements, headlined by vastly expanded support for Shortcuts. You can also search for text in images, use the W3C HTML syntax checker, and of all things, use vi keyboard emulation. There's a lot more, of course, and as always the changes, improvements, and additions are copiously documented in the release notes. New licenses are \$60, upgrades from v15 cost \$30, and upgrades from older versions are \$40. In the Mac App Store it's a \$5/month or \$50/year subscription. See also: Jason Snell at Six Colors and Adam Engst at TidBITS.

6. ArtfulType: Markdown Writing App for the 68K Macintosh

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-07-17T17:05:20Z

Link: <https://github.com/ActionRetro/ArtfulType>

Sean Malseed's Action Retro on YouTube created a Markdown editor for the original Macintosh. Source code on GitHub; intro video on YouTube. It's written in C, not Pascal, and uses the modern Retro68 GCC-derived compiler. I absolutely love that this exists. I don't like the actual app at all. I guess full screen mode is the point of some distraction-free editors, but I for one would never look twice at a Mac app that didn't use windows. Full-screen mode just wasn't a thing back then, except for games. ArtfulType is not a Mac-assed 1984 Mac app. If I wanted to write in Markdown on a classic Mac, I'd use BBEdit, which was the app I originally created Markdown for use in. And one of two apps I primarily still use it in. But BBEdit won't run on an original 128 KB Macintosh, because Rich Siegel didn't create it until 1989, and the earliest public version was BBEdit 2 in 1992. BBEdit 2.1.3 does run in System 5 on Infinite Mac, but crashes if launched on System 3. I 100 percent see the appeal of using a 1980s retro Mac, but I don't see the appeal of using one that can't run System 6.

7. Happy iCal Day

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-07-17T16:55:59Z

Link: <https://www.threads.com/@joannastern/post/Da5rglvjrLM>

Joanna Stern explains why this emoji is correct today: 📅. (This one too: 📅) 📅

8. Making an agile version of a Windows Runtime delegate in C++/WinRT, part 3

Source: The Old New Thing | Published: Wed, 22 Jul 2026 14:00:00 +0000

Link: <https://devblogs.microsoft.com/oldnewthing/20260722-00/?p=112552>

The object that actively refuses to be marshaled. The post Making an agile version of a Windows Runtime delegate in C++/WinRT, part 3 appeared first on The Old New Thing.

9. Everyone Should Know SIMD

Source: Mitchell Hashimoto | Published: Wed, 22 Jul 2026 00:00:00 GMT

Link: <https://mitchellh.com/writing/everyone-should-know-simd>

(No summary)

10. Does creatine make you smarter?

Source: DYNOMIGHT | Published: 2026-07-22T00:00:00+00:00

Link: <https://dynamight.net/creatine/>

Is creatine a weird steroid-like hormone or drug? No. Creatine is a nutrient. Most omnivores eat a gram or two per day from meat. Your body also synthesizes a gram or two per day. You need creatine to deliver energy inside of cells. It is normal and non-weird. Does creatine increase testosterone? Unlikely. This concern comes from one study in 2009 on 16 male rugby players. 1 But that study is considered extremely suspect. There have been at least twelve other studies that all found no change or physiologically irrelevant changes. Beyond that, it's implausible that creatine would increase testosterone, because we know what creatine does and it has nothing to do with hormones. Does creatine make you go bald? No. Or, rather: No study ever

reported that. One study reported the opposite . There is no mechanistic reason to think that would happen. There are good mechanistic reasons to think that would not happen. These rumors all trace back to speculation built on top of that same single 2009 study. But that study is contradicted by later research, and anyway didn't measure hair. Anything is possible, but as far as I can tell, it's equally plausible that creatine would increase hair gr...

11. When sine of x degrees equals sine of x radians

Source: John D. Cook | Published: Wed, 22 Jul 2026 12:17:11 +0000

Link: <https://www.johndcook.com/blog/2026/07/22/degrees-radians/>

Ordinarily the sine of x radians and the sine of x degrees are very different numbers. Having your calculator in radian mode when it should be in degree mode, or vice versa, results in a major error. But sometimes it doesn't matter. A trivial example is when $x = 0$. A more interesting example is [?] The post When sine of x degrees equals sine of x radians first appeared on John D. Cook .

12. Scattered thoughts on social geolocation

Source: Terence Eden's Blog | Published: Wed, 22 Jul 2026 11:34:12 +0000

Link: <https://shkspr.mobi/blog/2026/07/scattered-thoughts-on-social-geolocation/>

I want to be able to share my location with my friends on social media. Twitter (RIP) had a way to attach an optional location to a post. Facebook still lets me check in to venues. But neither ActivityPub (Mastodon) nor AT Protocol (BlueSky) allow me to do that. I've been banging on about this for a while so was delighted to be invited to chat with the GeoSocial Task Force on their monthly call. ?

13. Package Name Prefixes

Source: Andrew Nesbitt | Published: 2026-07-23T00:00:00+00:00

Link: <https://nesbitt.io/2026/07/23/package-name-prefixes.html>

PEP 752 was accepted at the end of June. It lets an organisation apply to PyPI to reserve a package name prefix, after which new uploads matching that prefix are rejected unless they come from the grant holder. Existing packages are grandfathered. The motivation is impersonation: someone publishing malware as google-cloud-something or apache-something gets the vendor's name in front of it. The PEP names four example prefixes: google-cloud- , opentelemetry- , apache-airflow-providers- , and types- . I pulled every package name from PyPI (912,665 of them, via `ecosyste.ms`) and counted prefixes. Those four account for 264, 271, 154, and 1,295 packages respectively, and each is published almost entirely by one organisation. Google publishes google-cloud-* , the OpenTelemetry project publishes opentelemetry-* , the Apache Airflow team publishes apache-airflow-providers-* , and the typeshed maintainers publish types-* . Prefix reservation formalises what those publishers already do; one of the PEP's authors, Jarek Potiuk, is on the Airflow PMC . There are 13,934 prefixes on PyPI shared by five or more packages. The biggest is django-* with 17,450, published by thousands of different aut...

14. The Subprime Data Center Crisis

Source: Ed Zitron's Where's Your Ed At | Published: Wed, 22 Jul 2026 16:08:51 GMT

Link: <https://www.wheresyoured.at/the-subprime-data-center-crisis/>

Thanks for reading this week's free Where's Your Ed At newsletter. Friday's premium newsletter will ask the simple question: Is Oracle dying? It's been one year since I launched the premium newsletter, and I've decided to extend the discount

15. Not just development, distribution of software may change as well

Source: antirez.com | Published: Wed, 22 Jul 2026 16:52:39 +0200

Link: <http://antirez.com/news/170>

Even if you are as averse to semver as I used to be in the course of my programming activity, you can still think of open source software distribution as something that used to follow a fixed number of steps. There is a branch where developments happen, and this branch oftentimes

happens to be not really ready for reliable work. Then you freeze the developments for a certain amount of time (even if, in the meantime, the work can continue on some new unstable branch), fix bugs, ask people to test it. At some point the number of bug reports starts to drop, your team and your users start to believe there are no longer obvious critical flaws that are easy to discover in the next few weeks: then you call the branch 2.4 or whatever, and that's it. However now, with AI coding, it's not just development that has changed, but also the act itself of using software is affected: it is not just you that can ask an AI to do certain changes to the software, but also the recipient of the software itself. This is obvious in the domains where a piece of software has its main user base among programmers, but this is also true in general, as more and more technologically inclined users have AI access...

16. John C. Dvorak has died

Source: Old Vintage Computing Research | Published: 2026-07-22T18:02:38.986-07:00

Link: <https://oldvcr.blogspot.com/2026/07/john-c-dvorak-has-died.html>

Reports coming in of the death of John C. Dvorak, apparently passed away on Monday (July 20th) from complications of heart bypass surgery . Dvorak started in wine and moved to silicon as an early columnist at InfoWorld, one of the pillar references for this particular blog because of its studious regular reporting, and most notably for PC Magazine where he had no less than two columns since at least 1986. In addition to this and other tech journalism credits, he was on the flagship CNET Central cable TV program in the mid 1990's with his "Buy It, Try It, Skip It" reviews, plus other shows hosted on NPR and then-ZDTV. He was also a regular guest on Leo LaPorte's syndicated radio program and podcasts, and joined former MTV veejay Adam Curry (well known to us in Gopherspace for MTV Networks v. Curry , and an early user of TTYtter before Twitter started to suck) in 2007 as co-host of the No Agenda podcast, a role he maintained until his death . Dvorak hailed from a different generation of tech journalists, far more personal and yet far more technical, and even his detractors (given his political views, which we won't talk about here, there are many) would admit he was at least enterta...

17. How to Get Meaningful Feedback on Your Design Document

Source: Refactoring English | Published: Mon, 03 Nov 2025 00:00:00 +0000

Link: <https://refactoringenglish.com/blog/useful-feedback-on-design-docs/>

You've spent weeks carefully writing a design document for your software project, but what happens next? How can you get useful feedback from your teammates? How do you prevent your design review from devolving into petty arguments? I've been through many design reviews in my career as both the author and reviewer, and I have a special fondness for effective reviews. Through trial and error, I've learned techniques that help the review process move smoothly and yield material improvements to the design.

18. The first known runaway AI agent - or a very bad marketing stunt?

Source: Martin Alderson | Published: Wed, 22 Jul 2026 00:00:00 GMT

Link: https://martinalderson.com/posts/huggingface-openai-exploit/?utm_source=rss&utm_medium=rs&utm_campaign=feed

Breaking down the Hugging Face security incident caused by OpenAI's own models during a benchmark run - the sandbox escape, the package proxy, and whether it's really a marketing stunt.

19. Announcing the Portal open beta

Source: Keygen Blog | Published: Wed, 22 Jul 2026 05:00:00 GMT

Link: <https://keygen.sh/blog/announcing-portal-open-beta/>

Introducing Portal, Keygen's brand new open source dashboard.

20. Pluralistic: Trump's America can't even win a rigged game (22 Jul 2026)

Source: Pluralistic: Daily links from Cory Doctorow | Published: Wed, 22 Jul 2026 08:58:31 +0000

Link: <https://pluralistic.net/2026/07/22/table-flipper/>

Today's links Trump's America can't even win a rigged game: America has created a post-American world. Hey look at this: Delights to delectate. Object permanence: "Fagin"; Scott McCloud on comics' future; Laurie Penny on Milo Yiannopoulos; Singaporean regulator rap; Conservatives as bitter rubes. Upcoming appearances: Edinburgh, Sydney, Melbourne, Brighton, London, South Bend. Recent appearances: Where I've been. Latest books: You keep readin' em, I'll keep writin' 'em. Upcoming books: Like I said, I'll keep writin' 'em. Colophon: All the rest. Trump's America can't even win a rigged game (permalink) Here's a sentence that stopped me in my tracks last week: "The statement that 'the cemeteries are full of indispensable people' is just as true of nations, and in particular the US": <https://crookedtimber.org/2026/07/16/55382/> The writer is John Quiggin, writing about the fact that, under Trump, the world has raced through a series of seismic shifts in how it organizes itself, rushing to fill an America-shaped void in its dealings. This is a subject that's very much on my mind. As November Kelly says, Trump inherited a poker game rigged in his favor and then flipped the table over bec...